



CLINIKK

Launched: 2018

Founders: Bhavjot Kaur and Dr Suraj Baliga

Funding: Raised \$6.4 million in seed and pre-Series A round

Number of subscribers: More than 50,000 families

USP: Operates its own health hubs with an in-house

medical team

Offerings: Subscription with unlimited free OPD care; and cashless hospitalisation of ₹5 lakh (plus up to ₹50 lakh with super top-up)

Premium: ₹500-800 per month

Network: 16 health centres in Bengaluru, 2 in Hyderabad



KENKO HEALTH

Launched: 2019

Founders: Aniruddha Sen and Dhiraj Goel

Funding: \$12 million in Series A

Number of subscribers: Over 100,000

Offerings: 20-90% off on medicines,

tech helps us deliver faster benefits transfer and proof-processing, and better risk assessment with affordable pricing,” says Co-founder Aniruddha Sen. The common thread among these start-ups is strategy: they break down large premiums into smaller payments, making the product affordable and accessible. Consumers want to try out a service before committing, and it means greater flexibility and control over services without burning a hole in their pockets.

“Currently there’s a lot of traction for the idea of group health insurance being sold to smaller companies who are not targeted [by traditional insurers]. It’s a good idea because group health [insurance] was largely in the domain of large brokers, and for them it

wasn’t efficient to cater to companies that have 10-100 employees,” says Shanai Ghosh, CEO and Executive Director at Edelweiss General Insurance. Their growing popularity can be observed in funding. Recently, Onsurity raised \$16 million in a Series A round led by Quona Capital, alongside existing investors Nexus Venture Partners. Clinikk, too, raised \$6.4 million in seed and pre-Series A round led by MassMutual Ventures, while Kenko Health raised \$12 million as part of its Series A round led by Sequoia Capital India.

REGULATORY HURDLES

The rising interest in subscription-based insurance models makes the sector a high-growth market. But, there is the hurdle of clear regula-

tions. The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) provides two types of licences: One is a distribution licence and the other is the tough-to-get insurer (manufacturing) licence. “There are two types of risks in forming an insurance company. First is the capital risk that requires insurance companies to set aside capital to meet a policyholder’s claims. Then there are regulatory risks that are required to be met to protect the interests of policyholders,” explains Abhishek Poddar, Co-founder and CEO of Plum, an employee benefits-focussed firm.

Hence, while companies like Plum and Nova Benefits are licensed distributors under IRDAI’s ambit, managed-care players like Kenko, Onsurity and Even Health-